

Metals & Mining: Met Coal: China supply outage may present upward pressure on Seaborne prices

On 22 May 2026, a fatal gas explosion at the Liushenyu Coal Mine in Qinyuan county, Shanxi, triggered local voluntary mine suspensions and raised the potential for broader regulatory safety measures. We take no view on supply recovery timelines, but attempt to quantify the potential annualised impact of the outages, refresh our import arb charts for Australia PLV HCC into China, and assess NTM EBITDA sensitivities to coking coal prices for GLEN and BHP.

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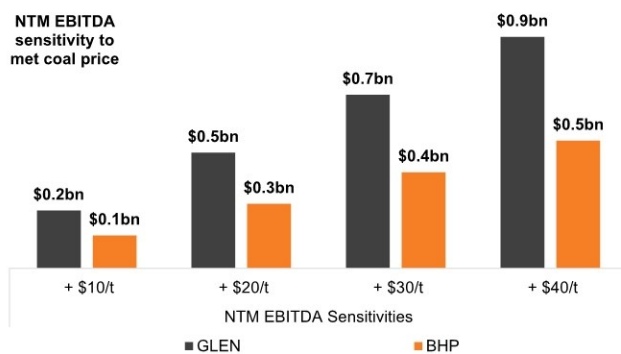
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- **Initial estimates suggest up to ~40Mt (~80Mt ROM) annualised production could be impacted (~8% domestic output):** The impacted mine has capacity of ~1.2Mtpa, but reports suggest a wider shutdown in Qinyuan county could impact ~25Mt of annualised ROM met coal. Wider implications (mandatory temporary safety shutdowns/inspections) could bring the total impact closer to ~80Mtpa. Based on China's 2025 domestic coking coal output of ~480Mt and assuming a yield factor of 50%, the annualised impact of the incident could be ~8% of clean domestic coking coal output; however, we believe it is unlikely this capacity will be completely offline for an extended period due to the voluntary nature of the shutdowns. A potential offsetting factor for the temporary supply outage is the lowering seasonal demand from India (monsoon season) for spot cargoes, which may temper near-term expectations of a deficit emerging in the seaborne market.
- **Depending on length and scope, Shanxi suspensions could pose a risk to China's coal blend:** Since 2020, China has reduced its dependence on Australian met coal imports; it has increasingly turned to Mongolia (Exhibit 2) and Russia (Exhibit 3), removing dependency from Australia (Exhibit 4). The emerging supply of coal from Shanxi has been critical to coal blends, as it complements the coal from Russia/Mongolia to produce a suitable met coke without the need for imports from Australia, displacing it as a key seaborne supplier. While the timeline and scope of the safety-related disruptions are unclear, the loss of supply from Shanxi could disrupt the ability for steel mills to blend coal to meet specifications, forcing mills to turn to the seaborne market to secure premium tonnes, which could benefit Australian and Canadian producers. We also note that Mongolia relies heavily on trucking for mine to border transportation, and diesel prices and availability could pose further supply risks in 2H'26. For now, however, import data shows that Mongolian exports are ~70% higher YoY for Jan-Apr'26.

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- **China price increases needed to open import arbitrage for Australian coal**
(Exhibit 6): On our estimates, China CFR prices need to increase a further ~\$37/t to incentivise imports of Australian coals (Exhibit 6); for a while now, China prices have been undercutting Australian coals (Exhibit 7), and increasing seaborne freight rates further reduce competitiveness (Exhibit 5).
- **Across our coverage, GLEN & BHP are positioned favourably if seaborne prices recover as both offer metallurgical coal exposure:** The majority of GLEN's met coal comes from their Canadian operation (EVR), which is not subject to the same royalties and has ~\$15/t higher all-in margins vs. Australian (Queensland) peers, which face onerous royalties that limit pricing upside. Based on a +\$10/t move in QLD Met coal prices, we would expect an uplift to NTM EBITDA (Exhibit 1) of +\$0.2bn for GLEN (+1.2% GSe EBITDA) and +\$0.1bn for BHP (+0.5%). On our estimates GLEN also offers more upside due to higher production volumes and Canadian vs QLD royalties - this also excludes any potential upside from GLEN's marketing division.

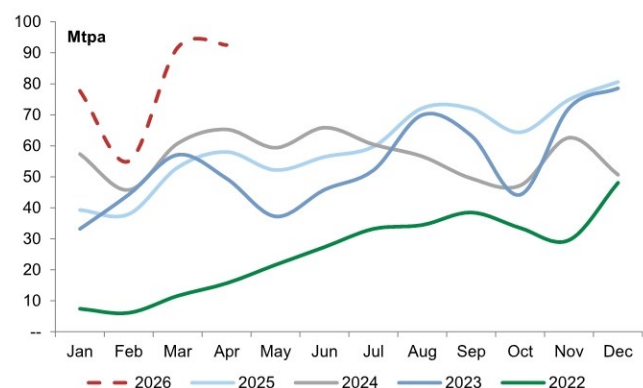
Exhibit 1: GLEN is more favourably exposed to upside to moves in met coal prices due to more volumes and a favourable royalty regime in Canada vs QLD Australia
NTM EBITDA sensitivities to moves in QLD FOB met coal prices vs. GS base case



NTM EBITDA is a sum of calendar 2H'26 (GSe \$195/t vs spot of \$241) and 1H'27 (GSe \$205/t) GSe. Our sensitivity does not reflect any uplift from GLEN's potential Marketing margin expansion.

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

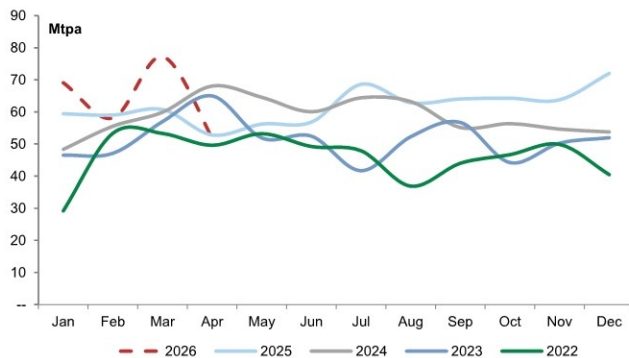
Exhibit 2: China imports are dominated by Mongolia (~50% in 2025), with 2026 volumes up ~70% YTD compared to the same period last year
China Coking Coal Import Volumes: Mongolia



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Total Russian exports have increased ~10% compared to the same period last year, but April exports are trending broadly in line with 2025

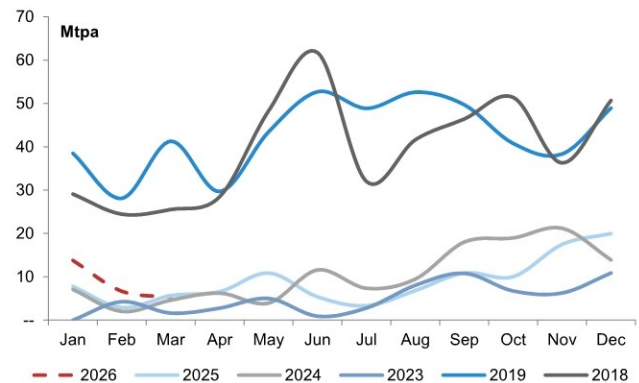
Total Russia Coking Coal Export Volumes



Source: Argus Media, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Australia remains a small share of China imports (~7% in 2025), with Aus exports to China down materially from pre-2020

Australia Coking Coal Export Volumes to China



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: Seaborne coal freight rates have stepped up \$5-10/t since the ME conflict started, Seaborne freight (\$/t) - Australia to China



Source: Bloomberg, Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

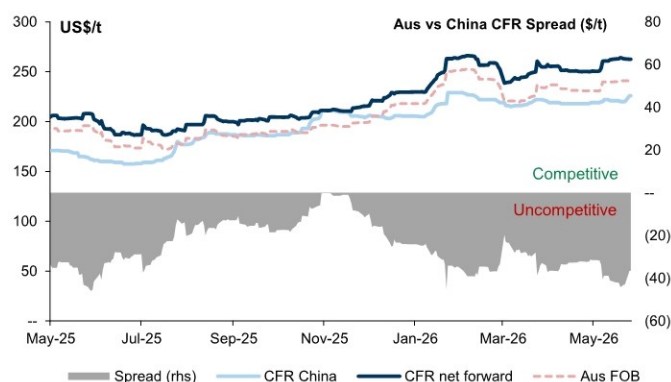
Exhibit 6: Based on spot FOB, China CFR and freight, we estimate a ~\$37/t spread needs to tighten (higher China prices) to incentivise Australian imports
HCC Aus-China arb at spot prices



Source: Bloomberg, Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: Higher freight has contributed to keeping the China import arb closed, leaving Australian coal uncompetitive for the time being

China HCC netback to Aus QLD vs. FOB price (spot)



Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Platts, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target, Methodologies and Investment Risks

We are Neutral Rated on GLEN.L. Our 12m TP is £6.0/sh set at 50:50 1x NAV and 6.5x EV/EBITDA.

Investment risks: (1) Coal, copper, and zinc metal price volatility; (2) Operational uncertainty, including labour-related risks (availability, industrial action), technical disruptions and external impacts such as extreme weather; (3) Material commodity price movements and logistical challenges that could impact the marketing division; (4) Higher capex and opex owing to industry cost inflation; (5) Strategic uncertainty surrounding M&A, given the Buy vs. Build dynamics facing the industry.

We continue to rate BHP.L a Neutral. Our NAV is £32.7/sh and our 12m PT is £29. Our 12m PT is set at an equal 50:50 blend of NAV and EV/EBITDA with a 6x target multiple.

Investment risks: (1) Macro factors: FX (AUD, CLP, CAD), commodity prices over the next 12 months, (2) Fluctuating operating costs and capex, (3) Project execution timelines, (4) Fiscal risks, (5) External M&A, (6) Ongoing and higher charges with rehabilitation at Samarco in Brazil.

Disclosure Appendix

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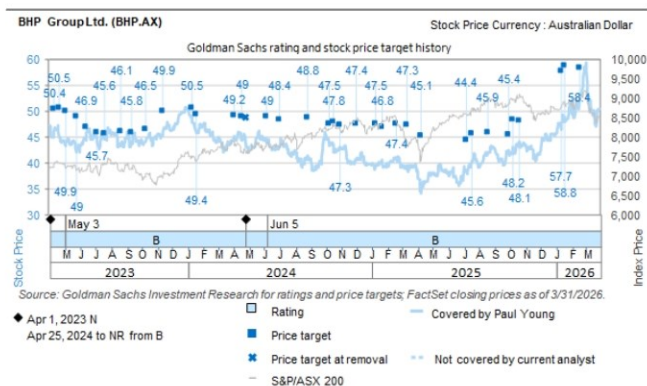
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Goldman Sachs Investment Research global Equity coverage universe

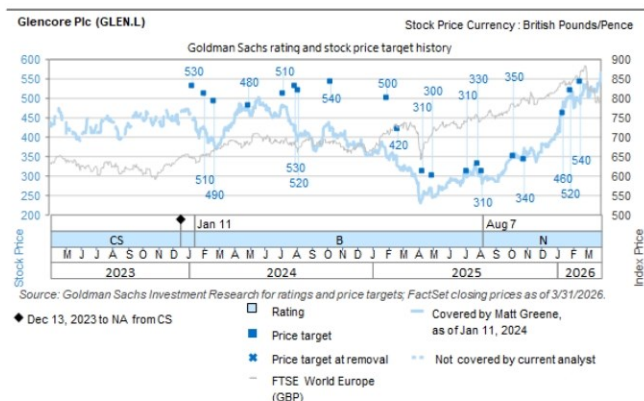
	Rating Distribution			Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%	65%	60%	45%

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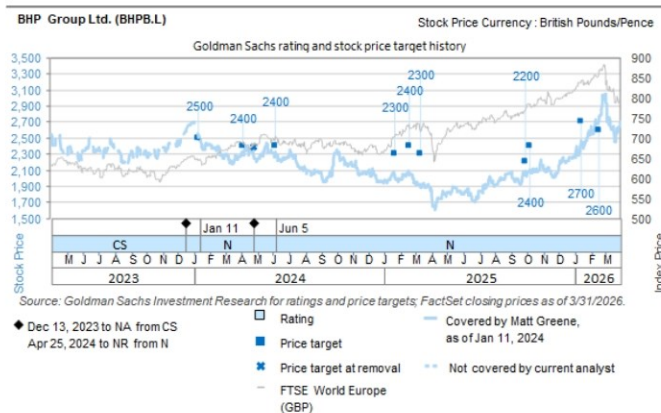
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Target price history table(s)

Glencore Plc (GLEN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
30-Apr-26	600	567.8
10-Apr-26	610	565.7
19-Feb-26	540	505
29-Jan-26	520	507.9
14-Jan-26	460	484.2
30-Oct-25	340	365.35
09-Oct-25	350	357.15
07-Aug-25	310	280.45
31-Jul-25	330	304.75

BHP Group Ltd. (BHP.AX)

Date of report	Target price (A\$)	Closing price (A\$)
11-May-26	58.50	58.33
22-Apr-26	58.40	56.17
13-Apr-26	57.10	54.35
09-Apr-26	56.70	54.56
17-Feb-26	58.40	52.74
20-Jan-26	58.80	47.78
12-Jan-26	57.70	46.51
21-Oct-25	48.10	44.13
08-Oct-25	48.20	41.89

Glencore Plc (GLEN.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
08-Jul-25	310	306.4
30-Apr-25	300	244.4
10-Apr-25	310	245
20-Feb-25	420	325.55
30-Jan-25	500	352.95
11-Oct-24	540	424.25
07-Aug-24	520	404.2
31-Jul-24	530	429.8
09-Jul-24	510	476.05
30-Apr-24	480	467.7
22-Feb-24	490	379.9
02-Feb-24	510	417.6
11-Jan-24	530	445.2

BHP Group Ltd. (BHP.AX)

Date of report	Target price (A\$)	Closing price (A\$)
29-Sep-25	45.40	41.91
19-Aug-25	45.90	42.12
18-Jul-25	45.60	40.29
07-Jul-25	44.40	38.60
08-Apr-25	45.10	35.38
12-Mar-25	47.30	38.95
18-Feb-25	47.40	40.97
21-Jan-25	46.80	40.61
09-Jan-25	47.50	39.27
01-Dec-24	47.40	40.57
29-Oct-24	47.30	43.04
17-Oct-24	47.80	42.99
08-Oct-24	47.50	43.79
27-Aug-24	48.80	41.35
02-Jul-24	48.40	43.16
05-Jun-24	49.00	43.90
18-Apr-24	49.00	45.09
03-Apr-24	49.20	44.86
18-Jan-24	49.40	45.73
10-Jan-24	50.50	47.86
14-Nov-23	49.90	46.02
10-Oct-23	46.50	44.15
11-Sep-23	45.80	43.66
22-Aug-23	46.10	43.21
20-Jul-23	45.60	44.62
05-Jul-23	45.70	45.00
13-Jun-23	46.90	44.29

BHP Group Ltd. (BHPB.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
10-Apr-26	2,900	2,879.5
17-Feb-26	2,600	2,715
14-Jan-26	2,700	2,440
09-Oct-25	2,400	2,114
29-Sep-25	2,200	2,093
12-Mar-25	2,300	1,880
18-Feb-25	2,400	2,065
21-Jan-25	2,300	2,040
05-Jun-24	2,400	2,282
04-Apr-24	2,400	2,328
11-Jan-24	2,500	2,481.5

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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